

Accounts Module

Practical Guide

Understanding Each Module with Real School Examples

When to Use Each Module & How They Work Together

St. Francis Of Assisi Private School

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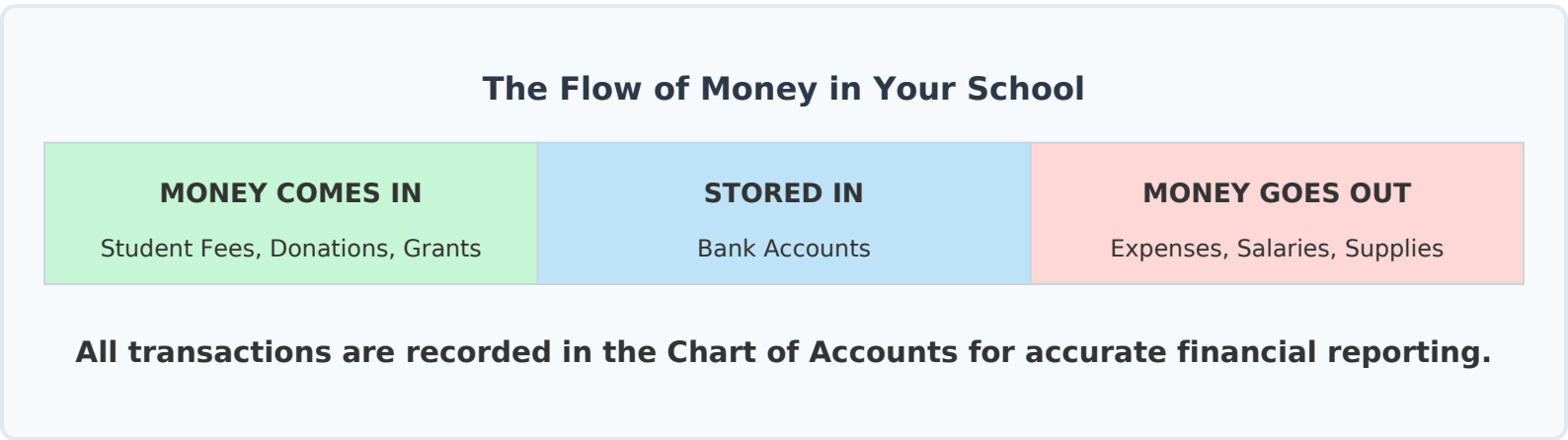
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1. Introduction & Module Overview

This guide provides a practical, hands-on understanding of the Accounts Module. Each section explains what the module does, when you should use it, and includes real examples from school operations.

How the Modules Connect



Module Summary

Module	Purpose	When to Use
Dashboard	Overview of financial status	Daily - to check balances and pending items
Chart of Accounts	Categories for all transactions	Setup once, rarely modified
Bank Accounts	Track school bank accounts	When opening/managing bank accounts
Bank Transactions	Record deposits & withdrawals	Daily - when money moves in/out
Expense Categories	Organize spending types	Setup initially, update as needed
Vendors/Suppliers	Manage who you pay	When adding new suppliers
Expenses	Record all spending	Whenever money is spent
Payment Vouchers	Authorize payments	Before making any payment
Financial Reports	Generate reports	Weekly/Monthly for management

2. Accounts Dashboard

What is the Accounts Dashboard?

The Accounts Dashboard is your **financial control center**. It provides a real-time snapshot of your school's financial health, showing key metrics, recent transactions, and alerts that need your attention.

Key Features

- **Total Bank Balance:** Combined balance across all school bank accounts
- **Income This Month:** All money received (fees, donations, etc.)
- **Expenses This Month:** All money spent
- **Pending Vouchers:** Payment requests awaiting approval
- **Recent Transactions:** Last 10 financial activities
- **Fee Collection Status:** How much of expected fees has been collected

When to Use the Dashboard

Situation	What to Look For	Action to Take
Start of each day	Bank balances, pending vouchers	Plan payments for the day
Before making large payment	Available bank balance	Ensure sufficient funds
Weekly review	Income vs Expenses	Identify cash flow issues
Board meeting prep	All key metrics	Prepare financial summary

EXAMPLE: Morning Check

Scenario: Mrs. Nakamya, the accountant, logs in at 8:00 AM on Monday.

Dashboard Shows:

- Main Account Balance: UGX 45,000,000
- Pending Vouchers: 3 (totaling UGX 2,500,000)
- Fee Collection This Term: 78% collected

Action: She sees sufficient funds to approve the 3 pending vouchers for supplier payments, then follows up on the 22% uncollected fees.

3. Chart of Accounts

What is the Chart of Accounts?

The Chart of Accounts is the **backbone of your accounting system**. It's a complete list of every category used to classify financial transactions. Think of it as a filing system for money.

Account Types Explained

Type	What It Tracks	School Examples
Assets	What the school OWNS	Bank accounts, furniture, computers, buildings
Liabilities	What the school OWES	Loans, unpaid supplier bills, staff advances
Equity	Owner's stake/reserves	School development fund, retained surplus
Income/Revenue	Money coming IN	School fees, donations, rental income
Expenses	Money going OUT	Salaries, utilities, supplies, maintenance

Standard School Chart of Accounts

Code	Account Name	Type	Used For
1000	Stanbic Bank - Main	Asset	Primary operating account
1001	Centenary Bank - Fees	Asset	Fee collection account
1100	Petty Cash	Asset	Small daily expenses
1200	Accounts Receivable	Asset	Outstanding student fees
2000	Accounts Payable	Liability	Unpaid supplier bills
3000	School Development Fund	Equity	Reserves for development
4000	Tuition Fees	Income	Student tuition payments

4100	Boarding Fees	Income	Boarding student payments
4200	Transport Fees	Income	Bus service payments
5000	Salaries & Wages	Expense	Staff payments
5100	Utilities	Expense	Electricity, water, internet
5200	Supplies	Expense	Office and teaching materials

When to Use Chart of Accounts

Setup Phase (Once): Create all accounts when first setting up the system. This is typically done by the accountant with guidance from management.

Ongoing: You don't interact with this directly often. The accounts are selected automatically when recording expenses, income, or bank transactions.

When to Add New Accounts:

- New income source (e.g., school starts offering swimming lessons)
- New expense type (e.g., school buys a bus - need "Vehicle Expenses")
- New bank account opened

4. Bank Accounts

What is the Bank Accounts Module?

This module is where you **register and manage all school bank accounts**. Every bank account the school holds should be set up here. This enables tracking of balances and transactions per account.

Information Stored

- **Bank Name:** e.g., Stanbic Bank, Centenary Bank
- **Account Name:** As it appears on the account
- **Account Number:** Full account number
- **Account Type:** Current, Savings, Fixed Deposit
- **Opening Balance:** Balance when you start using the system
- **Current Balance:** Automatically calculated
- **Status:** Active or Inactive

When to Use This Module

Situation	Action	Example
Initial system setup	Add all existing bank accounts	Add Stanbic Main Account, Centenary Fees Account
Opening new bank account	Create new bank account record	School opens savings account for building fund
Closing bank account	Mark account as inactive	Consolidating accounts, close old account
Monthly reconciliation	Compare system balance vs bank statement	End of month bank reconciliation

EXAMPLE: Setting Up Bank Accounts

Scenario: St. Francis Primary School has 3 bank accounts:

Bank	Account Name	Purpose	Opening Balance
Stanbic Bank	St. Francis Operating Account	Day-to-day expenses, salaries	UGX 25,000,000
Centenary Bank	St. Francis Fees Collection	Receive student fee payments	UGX 15,000,000
DFCU Bank	St. Francis Development Fund	Savings for capital projects	UGX 50,000,000

Action: Create 3 bank account records with the above details. The system will now track each account separately.

How Bank Accounts Connect to Other Modules

Bank Accounts Integration

Student Fees Module → When students pay fees, money goes into a Bank Account



Bank Transactions → Records the deposit in the selected bank account



Expenses/Payment Vouchers → When paying, money comes out of a Bank Account



Financial Reports → Shows balance and movement per Bank Account

5. Bank Transactions

What are Bank Transactions?

Bank Transactions record **every movement of money** in and out of your bank accounts. This is the most frequently used module - you'll create records here almost daily.

Transaction Types

Type	Direction	Examples
Deposit	Money IN	Fee payment, donation, grant received
Withdrawal	Money OUT	Cash withdrawal, payment made
Transfer	Between accounts	Move money from fees account to operating account

When to Use Bank Transactions

Scenario 1: Recording a Fee Payment Deposit

Situation: Parent pays UGX 1,500,000 school fees via bank deposit.

1

Go to Bank Transactions → Create New

2

Select Transaction Type: **Deposit**

3

Select Bank Account: **Centenary Fees Collection**

4

Enter Amount: **UGX 1,500,000**

5

Select Category: **Tuition Fees (Income)**

6

Reference: **Bank slip number or student name**

7

Save → Balance automatically updates

Scenario 2: Recording a Cash Withdrawal

Situation: Withdraw UGX 500,000 for petty cash.

1

Create new Bank Transaction

2

Type: **Withdrawal**

3

Bank Account: **Stanbic Operating**

4

Amount: **UGX 500,000**

5

Description: **Petty cash replenishment**

Scenario 3: Transferring Between Accounts

Situation: Transfer UGX 10,000,000 from Fees account to Operating account for salary payment.

1

Create new Bank Transaction

2

Type: **Transfer**

3

From Account: **Centenary Fees Collection**

4

To Account: **Stanbic Operating**

5

Amount: **UGX 10,000,000**

Description: **Transfer for January salaries**

TIP: Always enter transactions the same day they occur. This keeps your records accurate and makes monthly reconciliation easier.

6. Expense Categories

What are Expense Categories?

Expense Categories help you **organize and classify your spending**. They group similar expenses together, making it easier to analyze where your money goes and prepare budgets.

Why Categories Matter

- See spending patterns (e.g., "We spent 40% on salaries")
- Compare to budget ("Utilities 20% over budget")
- Generate reports by category
- Identify cost-saving opportunities

Standard School Expense Categories

Category	Description	Example Expenses
Salaries & Wages	Staff compensation	Teacher salaries, support staff wages, allowances
Utilities	Essential services	Electricity, water, internet, telephone
Teaching Materials	Educational supplies	Textbooks, chalk, charts, lab equipment
Office Supplies	Administrative materials	Paper, pens, files, printer cartridges
Maintenance	Repairs and upkeep	Building repairs, furniture repair, painting
Transport	Vehicle-related costs	Fuel, vehicle maintenance, driver allowances
Food & Catering	Meals and refreshments	Staff lunch, meeting refreshments, boarding food
Cleaning & Sanitation	Hygiene supplies	Detergents, brooms, toilet supplies
Security	Safety-related costs	Security guards, alarm systems, CCTV
Events & Functions	School activities	Sports day, graduation, prize giving

Professional Fees	External services	Audit fees, legal fees, consulting
Bank Charges	Banking costs	Transaction fees, account maintenance

When to Use Expense Categories

Setup Phase: Create all categories when first setting up the system. Review existing spending to ensure all types are covered.

Adding New Categories: When a new type of expense arises that doesn't fit existing categories (e.g., school starts ICT program → add "ICT Expenses" category).

EXAMPLE: Using Categories for Budget Analysis

At the end of Term 1, the Head Teacher asks: "What are our biggest expenses?"

The system generates a report showing:

Category	Amount (UGX)	% of Total
Salaries & Wages	35,000,000	58%
Utilities	5,500,000	9%
Teaching Materials	4,200,000	7%
Food & Catering	6,000,000	10%
Other	9,300,000	16%

Insight: This shows salaries are the main cost. If the school needs to reduce costs, focus should be on non-salary areas.

7. Vendors/Suppliers

What is the Vendors/Suppliers Module?

The Vendors module stores information about **all companies and individuals you make payments to**. This creates a database of your suppliers for easy reference and reporting.

Information Stored

- **Vendor Name:** Company or person name
- **Contact Person:** Who to call
- **Phone Number:** Contact details
- **Email:** For sending purchase orders
- **Address:** Physical location
- **TIN Number:** Tax Identification Number (for tax compliance)
- **Bank Details:** For electronic payments
- **Payment Terms:** e.g., "Net 30 days"

Types of School Vendors

Vendor Type	Examples	Common Purchases
Stationery Suppliers	Kampala Stationers, Office Mart	Paper, pens, files, exercise books
Book Suppliers	Fountain Publishers, MK Publishers	Textbooks, reference books
Food Suppliers	Fresh Foods Ltd, Grain Traders	Posho, beans, rice, cooking oil
Utility Companies	Umeme, NWSC	Electricity, water
Maintenance	ABC Builders, Plumber John	Repairs, construction
Fuel Suppliers	Shell Station, Total	Vehicle fuel, generator fuel
Service Providers	Security Co., Cleaning Services	Ongoing services

ICT Suppliers	Computer Point, Tech Solutions	Computers, printers, repairs
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When to Use the Vendors Module

Scenario: Adding a New Supplier

Situation: School finds a new stationery supplier with better prices.

1

Go to Vendors → Create New

2

Enter: **Quality Stationers Ltd**

3

Contact: **Mr. James Okello, 0772-123456**

4

TIN: **1001234567**

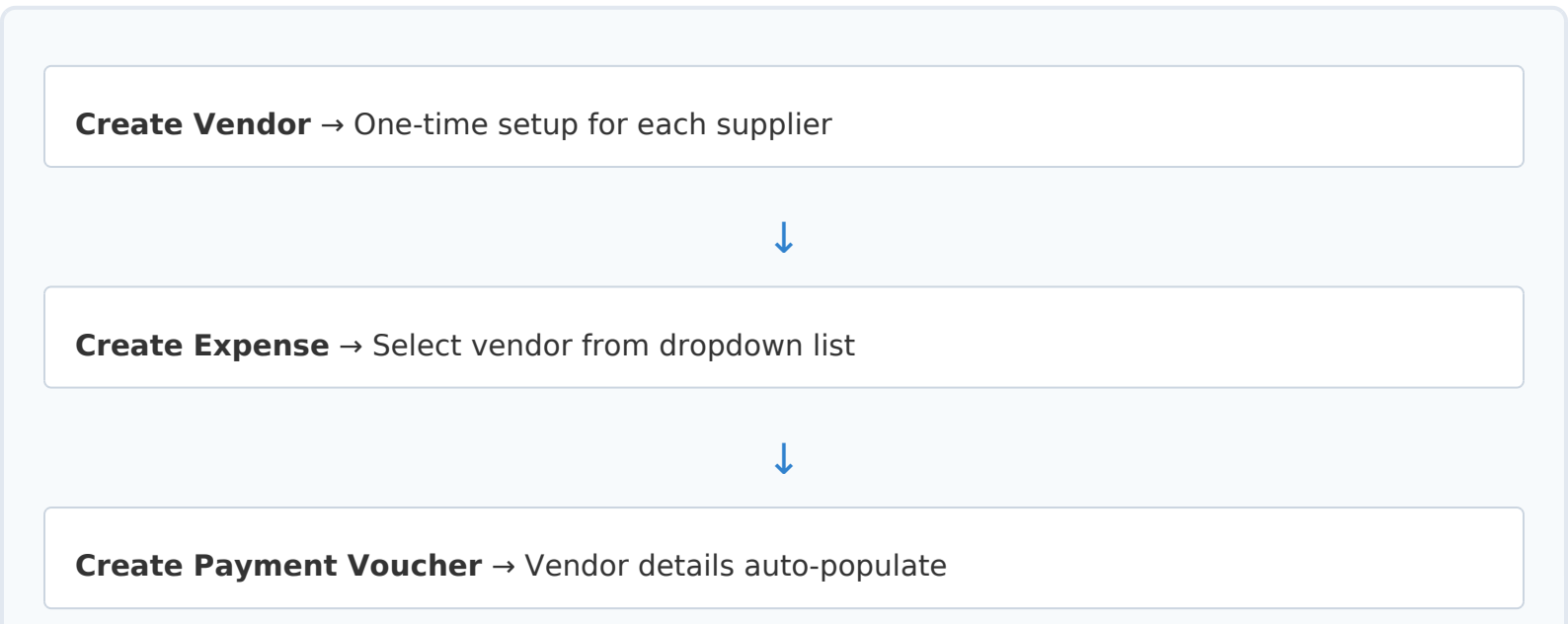
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Bank: **Stanbic Bank, A/C 9030012345678**

6

Terms: **Cash on delivery**

How Vendors Connect to Other Modules





Reports → See all payments made to each vendor

TIP: Always verify TIN numbers with URA before adding vendors. This ensures proper tax compliance and valid receipts.

8. Expenses

What is the Expenses Module?

The Expenses module is where you **record every purchase and payment** the school makes. This is one of the most frequently used modules - you'll create expense records almost daily.

Expense Record Contains

- **Date:** When the expense occurred
- **Vendor:** Who was paid (from vendors list)
- **Category:** Type of expense (from categories)
- **Description:** What was purchased
- **Amount:** How much was paid
- **Payment Method:** Cash, Cheque, Bank Transfer, Mobile Money
- **Bank Account:** Which account was used (if not cash)
- **Receipt/Invoice Number:** For reference
- **Attachments:** Scanned receipts/invoices

Common School Expenses

Daily/Weekly Expenses

Expense	Category	Typical Amount
Chalk and markers	Teaching Materials	UGX 50,000
Cleaning supplies	Cleaning & Sanitation	UGX 100,000
Printing paper	Office Supplies	UGX 150,000
Vehicle fuel	Transport	UGX 200,000

Monthly Expenses

Expense	Category	Typical Amount
Staff salaries	Salaries & Wages	UGX 15,000,000
Electricity bill	Utilities	UGX 800,000
Water bill	Utilities	UGX 200,000
Internet	Utilities	UGX 150,000
Security services	Security	UGX 500,000

When to Record Expenses

Payment Type	When to Record	Additional Steps
Cash payment (petty cash)	Same day as payment	Keep receipt for filing
Cheque payment	When cheque is issued	Create payment voucher first
Bank transfer	When transfer is made	Create payment voucher, confirm transfer
Mobile money	When payment sent	Keep transaction confirmation

Complete Example: Recording a Stationery Purchase

Situation: School buys exercise books worth UGX 500,000 from Quality Stationers.

1

Go to Expenses → Create New

2

Date: **Today's date**

3

Vendor: **Quality Stationers Ltd** (select from list)

4

Category: **Teaching Materials**

5

Description: **500 counter books (96 pages) for P5-P7**

6

Amount: **UGX 500,000**

7

Payment Method: **Cheque**

8

Bank Account: **Stanbic Operating Account**

9

Invoice #: **INV-2024-0892**

10

Attach: **Scanned invoice**

11

Save → Expense recorded, bank balance updated

9. Payment Vouchers

What are Payment Vouchers?

A Payment Voucher is an **official authorization document** that approves a payment before it's made. It creates a paper trail and ensures proper approval for all expenditures.

Why Payment Vouchers Matter

- **Control:** Prevents unauthorized spending
- **Approval Trail:** Shows who authorized each payment
- **Documentation:** Links payment to supporting documents
- **Audit Compliance:** Required for financial audits
- **Budget Control:** Ensures spending stays within limits

Payment Voucher Workflow

The Payment Voucher Process

Step 1: REQUEST

Staff member requests payment → Creates voucher with details



Step 2: REVIEW

Accountant reviews → Checks budget, supporting documents



Step 3: APPROVE

Head Teacher/Director approves → Signs voucher



Step 4: PAY

Accountant makes payment → Cheque or bank transfer



Step 5: RECORD

Expense recorded → Bank transaction created

Voucher Statuses

Status	Meaning	Next Action
Pending	Awaiting review	Accountant to review
Approved	Authorized for payment	Accountant to make payment
Rejected	Not approved	Requester informed, no payment
Paid	Payment completed	File voucher with receipt

Complete Example: Creating a Payment Voucher

Situation: The school needs to pay Umeme UGX 850,000 for electricity.

1

Accountant creates voucher:

- Payee: Umeme Uganda Limited
- Amount: UGX 850,000
- Purpose: Electricity bill for November 2024
- Category: Utilities
- Attach: Electricity bill scan

2

Head Teacher reviews:

- Checks budget for utilities
- Verifies bill is genuine
- Approves voucher in system

3

Accountant makes payment:

- Writes cheque or initiates bank transfer
- Updates voucher status to "Paid"
- Enters cheque number/transaction reference

4

System automatically:

- Creates expense record
- Updates bank balance
- Updates expense reports

When to Use Payment Vouchers

Payment Type	Voucher Required?	Reason
Supplier payments	YES	All supplier payments need approval
Utility bills	YES	Formal approval needed
Staff salaries	YES	Payroll approved monthly
Petty cash (small)	Optional	Can use petty cash vouchers instead
Large capital purchases	YES	May need Board approval too

IMPORTANT: Never make payments without proper voucher approval. This protects both the school and the accountant from fraud allegations.

10. Financial Reports

What are Financial Reports?

Financial Reports transform your daily transactions into **meaningful summaries** that help management make informed decisions. The system generates several types of reports.

Available Reports

Report	What It Shows	When to Use
Income Statement	Revenue minus Expenses = Profit/Loss	Monthly, termly, annually
Balance Sheet	Assets, Liabilities, Equity	End of term, year end, audits
Cash Flow Statement	Where money came from and went	Monthly cash planning
Bank Reconciliation	System balance vs Bank statement	Monthly
Expense Report	All expenses by category	Budget review meetings
Vendor Payment Report	Payments made to each supplier	Supplier negotiations, audits
Trial Balance	All account balances	Month end, before closing

Understanding Key Reports

Income Statement (Profit & Loss)

Sample Income Statement - Term 1, 2024

INCOME	
Tuition Fees	45,000,000
Boarding Fees	12,000,000

Transport Fees	3,500,000
Other Income	500,000
Total Income	61,000,000
EXPENSES	
Salaries & Wages	35,000,000
Utilities	2,500,000
Teaching Materials	4,000,000
Food (Boarding)	6,000,000
Maintenance	2,000,000
Other Expenses	3,500,000
Total Expenses	53,000,000
NET SURPLUS	8,000,000
Interpretation: The school made a surplus of UGX 8 million this term. This can be saved for development or emergencies.	

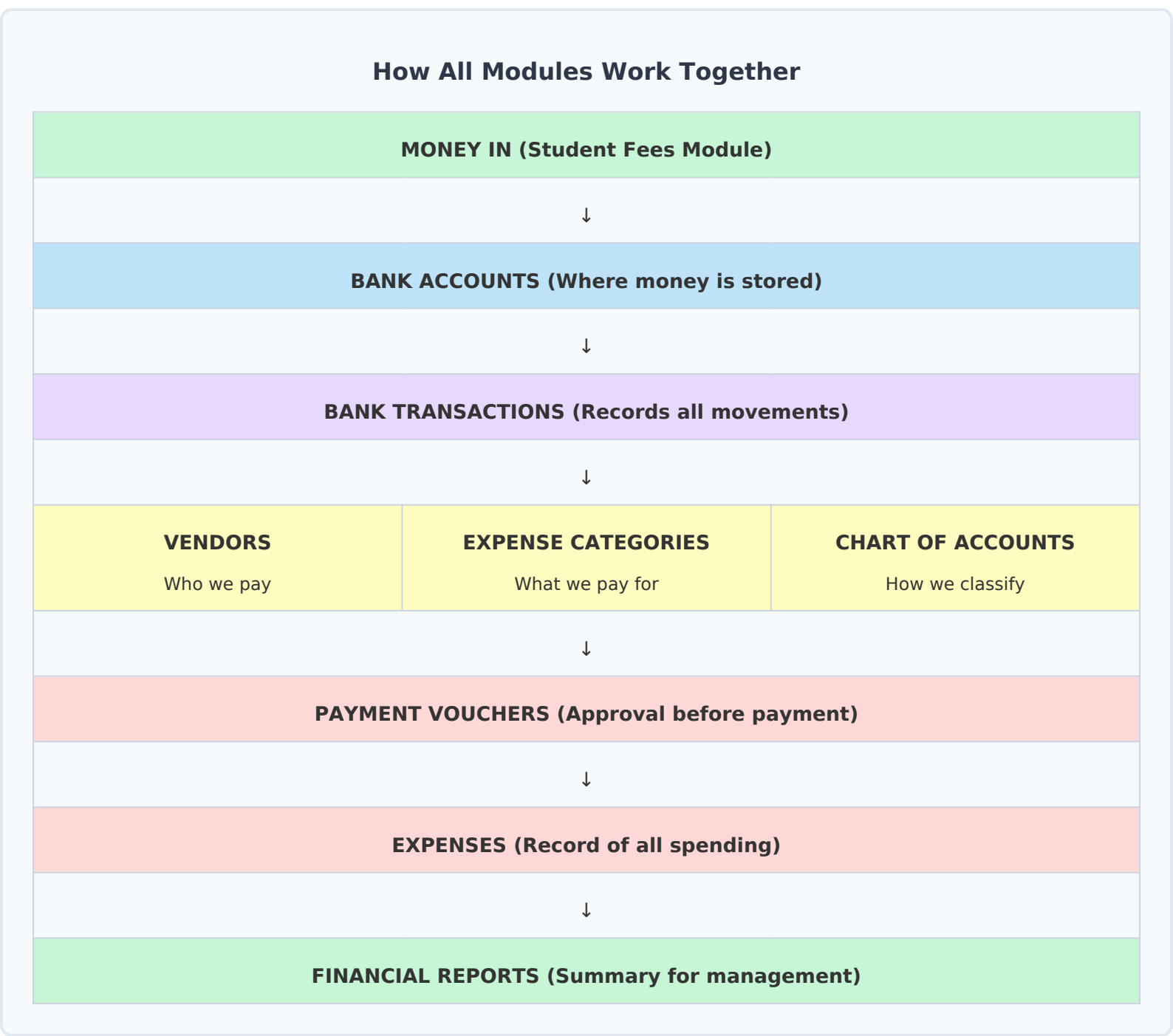
When to Generate Each Report

Frequency	Reports to Generate	Who Receives
Weekly	Cash Position, Outstanding Payments	Accountant, Head Teacher
Monthly	Income Statement, Bank Reconciliation, Expense Report	Head Teacher, Director
Termly	All financial statements, Fee Collection Report	Board of Directors
Annually	Complete Financial Statements, Audit Report	Board, Auditors, Regulators

11. Module Interactions Map

Understanding how modules connect helps you use the system effectively. Here's how data flows between modules:

The Complete Picture



Specific Module Connections

From Module	To Module	What Flows
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Student Fees	Bank Transactions	Fee payments become deposits
Bank Transactions	Bank Accounts	Updates account balances
Bank Transactions	Chart of Accounts	Creates journal entries
Vendors	Expenses	Supplier info for expenses
Expense Categories	Expenses	Classification for reporting
Payment Vouchers	Expenses	Approved vouchers become expenses
Expenses	Bank Transactions	Payments reduce bank balance
All Modules	Financial Reports	Data aggregated for reports

12. Complete Workflow Examples

Example 1: Complete Fee Collection to Expense Cycle

The Story: A Day in the School's Financial Life

Morning: Fee Collection

Parent John Mukasa pays UGX 1,200,000 for his daughter's Term 2 fees via bank deposit to Centenary Bank.

1

Fee Collection: Bursar records payment in Student Fees module

2

Auto-Created: Bank Transaction (Deposit) → Centenary Fees Account +1,200,000

3

Auto-Created: Journal Entry → DR: Bank, CR: Tuition Fees Income

Afternoon: Need to Pay Supplier

Accountant receives invoice from Quality Stationers for UGX 350,000 for exercise books.

4

Create Payment Voucher:

- Payee: Quality Stationers Ltd
- Amount: UGX 350,000
- Category: Teaching Materials
- Attach invoice

5

Head Teacher Approves: Reviews and approves in system

6

Accountant Pays: Transfers from Stanbic Operating to supplier bank account

7

Record Expense: Creates expense record with voucher reference

8

Auto-Created: Bank Transaction (Withdrawal) → Stanbic Account -350,000

End of Day: Dashboard Shows

- Centenary Fees Account: +1,200,000
- Stanbic Operating: -350,000
- Net Cash Position: +850,000
- Teaching Materials Expense: +350,000

Example 2: Monthly Salary Payment Process

End of Month Salary Processing

1

HR/Admin prepares payroll: List of all staff with their salaries

2

Check Bank Balance: Dashboard → Ensure sufficient funds in Operating Account

3

Transfer if needed: Move money from Fees Account to Operating Account

4

Create Salary Voucher:

- Description: Staff Salaries - January 2024
- Amount: Total payroll amount
- Attach: Approved payroll sheet

5

Get Approval: Head Teacher/Director approves

6

Process Payments: Pay each staff member (bank transfer or cash)

7

Record Expense: Salaries & Wages category

8

Update Voucher: Mark as Paid

Example 3: Adding a New Vendor and First Purchase

New Supplier Onboarding

Situation: School finds new supplier "Tech Solutions Ltd" for computer repairs.

1

Create Vendor:

- Name: Tech Solutions Ltd
- Contact: Peter Ochieng, 0755-987654
- TIN: 1009876543
- Bank: Equity Bank, A/C 0123456789

2

Check Expense Categories: Verify "ICT Expenses" category exists (create if not)

3

First Purchase - Computer Repair UGX 200,000:

- Create Payment Voucher
- Get Approval
- Make Payment
- Record Expense (Vendor auto-fills from database)

4

Future Purchases: Select "Tech Solutions Ltd" from dropdown - all details ready

13. Quick Reference Guide

Module Quick Reference

I Want To...	Go To...	Steps
Check school's financial position	Dashboard	View summary cards and charts
Add a new bank account	Bank Accounts	Create → Enter bank details → Save
Record fee payment deposit	Bank Transactions	Create → Deposit → Select bank → Enter amount
Transfer between accounts	Bank Transactions	Create → Transfer → Select From/To accounts
Add a new supplier	Vendors	Create → Enter supplier details → Save
Request a payment	Payment Vouchers	Create → Enter details → Submit for approval
Record an expense	Expenses	Create → Select vendor/category → Enter amount
See monthly income vs expenses	Financial Reports	Income Statement → Select month → Generate
Reconcile bank account	Financial Reports	Bank Reconciliation → Select account → Compare
Add expense category	Expense Categories	Create → Enter name and description → Save

Best Practices Summary

Daily Tasks:

- Check Dashboard first thing in the morning
- Record all bank transactions the same day they occur
- Process pending payment vouchers
- Enter all expenses before end of day

Weekly Tasks:

- Review cash position across all accounts
- Follow up on outstanding fee balances
- Verify all receipts are attached to expenses

Monthly Tasks:

- Perform bank reconciliation for all accounts
- Generate and review Income Statement
- Compare actual expenses vs budget
- Report to Head Teacher/Board

Common Mistakes to Avoid

- **Don't:** Make payments without approved vouchers
- **Don't:** Delay entering transactions (enter same day)
- **Don't:** Forget to attach supporting documents
- **Don't:** Use wrong expense categories
- **Don't:** Skip monthly bank reconciliation
- **Don't:** Share login credentials with others

End of Accounts Module Practical Guide

St. Francis Of Assisi Private School

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